



LGBTQIA+ rights

Throughout history, LGBTQIA+ (lesbian, gay, bisexual, transgender, queer, intersex, and asexual) people have suffered unfair treatment in society because of who they are and who they love. For example, until the 20th century homosexuality was illegal in most countries—and in some countries it still is. There has been a lot of progress in the fight for the LGBTQIA+ community to have the same rights as everyone else in recent decades, but there is still a long way to go.

1900 TO PRESENT

THE FIGHT FOR EQUAL RIGHTS

1969

After police raid the Stonewall Inn, a gay bar in New York City, members of the gay community riot in protest. The event inspires the formation of a gay rights movement to campaign against discrimination (unfair treatment) toward LGBTQIA+ people.

1972

Sweden becomes the first country in the world to allow transgender people—those who feel that the gender they were assigned (given at birth) is not who they are—to change their gender by law.

2001

On April 1, the Netherlands becomes the first country in the world to legalize same-sex marriage. The first gay weddings (right) take place in Amsterdam shortly after midnight.



SAME-SEX COUPLES CUTTING CAKE

2015

The US legalizes same-sex marriage in all fifty of its states. By 2021, same-sex marriage is legal in 30 countries.

◀ PRIDE PARADE

On June 28, 1970, gay rights activists organized a march through New York City's streets to celebrate the first anniversary of the Stonewall riots. The Christopher Street Gay Liberation Day March, as it was called, was the first pride parade. Now pride events celebrating LGBTQIA+ culture take place in cities around the world and attract millions of people every year.